DESERTION

Project description by Marco Ciceri and Liam Andrews

Desertion

Desertion is an audiovisual performance that listens to metal and watches the wear that time leaves on it. Industrial objects and processes become both electronic instruments and sources of video texture, combined into a single composition. Starting from an idea of Einstürzende Neubauten, to “tickle out whatever is sleeping in the materials”, Liam Andrews and Marco Ciceri draw out the stories held on the surface of objects built to resist the passage of time, reading them in the wear of the material.

The stories in the material

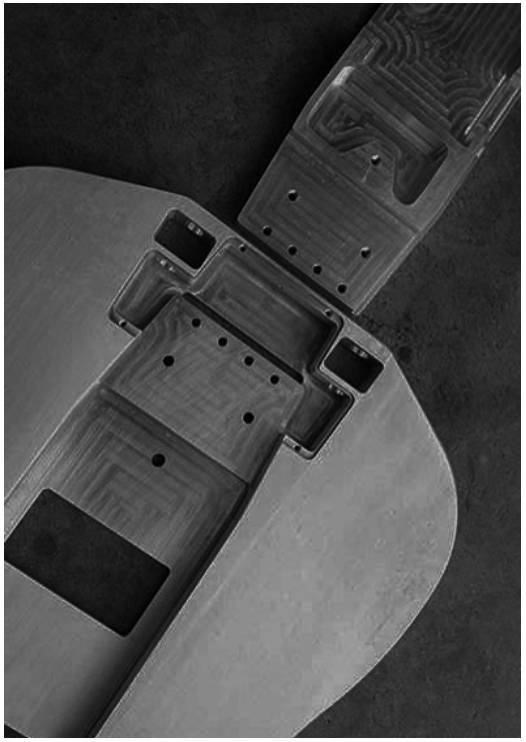
Every metal object used in Desertion is chosen for the life it has already lived. A ship’s plate scarred by salt, a machine part polished by years of friction, a railing worn by hands, a tool dented by repeated blows: each surface is an archive of use, accidents and time. Before an object enters the performance we trace where it comes from, what it was made for and what happened to it, and this research shapes how it is filmed and played. Under the macro cameras, scratches, rust and fatigue lines become landscapes; through pickups and piezoelectric sensors, the same marks become rhythm and resonance. The story is never told in words: it is read directly from the material, which speaks through its wear. Part of the objects will be sourced locally during the residency, so that each presentation carries the traces of the place where it is made.

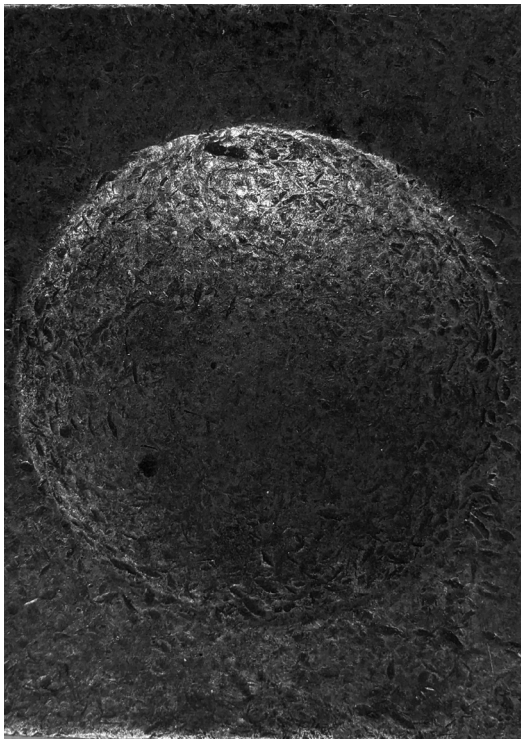
Collaboration

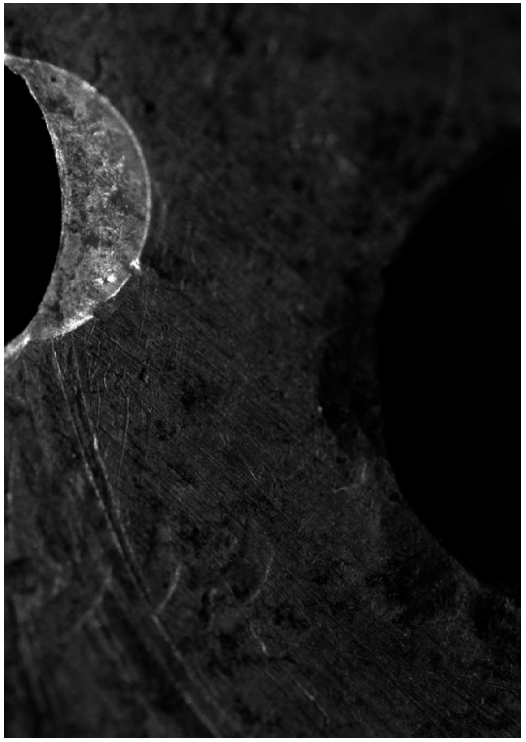
The collaboration grows out of a shared interest in minimal and material aesthetics: finding find detail within a cloud of noise and chaos, and building a relationship between live camera textures and dense, physical sound. Both artists are drawn to processes of precision, repetition,and transformation, and use performance as the space where these elements meet.

Through live processing and composition, sound, video, and light unfold in an environment that always originates from the physical behaviour of the material. Sound is never accompaniment: image and sound develop together, shaping one another throughout the performance.

The work is driven by experimentation rather than predefined outcomes, letting the characteristics of the materials guide the result. In this sense, Desertion treats sound and image as untamed matter, shaking them loose from conventional musical and visual structures.













The performance is conceived for two artists on stage. Liam Andrews performs with electronics and bass, while Marco Ciceri creates the visual component using live camera feeds and lighting. The work is designed for a dark performance space with a large projection screen, where the live visuals and sound are presented as equal elements of the performance.

HERE IS A VIDEO OF A SELECTED EXCERPT OF THE PERFORMANCE



marco-ciceri.com

Marco Ciceri is a Berlin-based Italian media artist and researcher working across live performance and installation. His practice combines sound, custom technologies, and moving image to investigate the hidden infrastructures of contemporary life through immersive audiovisual installations and performances. His work has been presented at Triennale Milano, the Barbican Centre, La Casa Encendida, and festivals including CTM, Berlin Atonal, MUTEK, and Terraforma. Ciceri studied Design and Art at the Free University of Bozen-Bolzano, where his thesis explored the relationship between live and mediated reality. After collaborating with Marshmallow Laser Feast in 2015, he joined Berlin's Pfadfinderei studio, creating visual content for internationally renowned artists, venues, and festivals. Alongside his independent practice, he has developed long-term collaborations with musicians including Alessandro Cortini, Grand River, and Boris Wilsdorf (Einstürzende Neubauten). Known for his flowing aesthetic, Ciceri integrates generative software and motorised mechanics to create dynamic, detailed animations that blur the boundary between physical and digital.



@liam_andrews

Liam Andrews is a musician and visual artist based in Europe. For the past two decades, Andrews has been active in exploring mass amplification and dissonant music with the post–punk group MY DISCO, and as a collaborator with Karl O'Connor (Regis, Sandwell District) and Boris Wilsdorf (Einstürzende Neubauten) as A Southern Code.

His recent work, as AICHER, focuses on repurposing the incidentals within spatial recordings. Working within the atonal and monochromatic aesthetics he's drawn to, and drawing on a vast catalogue of recorded material, he translates these fragments of sound into compositions of detailed feedback expression, seasick percussive roil and buckling subharmonic frequencies. The result is a collection of sonic movements, an assemblage of unsettling dissonance, that remain on the wire.

Defensive Acoustics, the debut album under the AICHER moniker, is a stark reflection of a performance held alongside his close collaborator Rohan Rebeiro in the basement of an abandoned, once ornate, pharmaceutical store in Kanazawa, Japan. The cavernous reverberation, structural deterioration, and the pressure of sound at the brink, is at the essence of the recording.

The album was released in an exclusive edition of 300 copies in 2025 on Downwards Records.

In 2024, he was invited to present the recorded material of Your Truth Is a Lie at the renowned Funkhaus Studios in Berlin, showcasing the work in an immersive multichannel surround sound environment, incorporating an A/V presentation in collaboration with visual artist Marco Ciceri.

As a recent contributor, he has worked with Ben Frost, on the 2024 album Scope Neglect (Mute Records) Regis, on the 2020 album Hidden In This Is The Light That You Miss (Downwards Records) BIG BRAVE, on the 2026 album In Grief Or In Hope, and Dis Fig, on the 2026 album What To Make Of These Mortal Hands.

Andrews has performed at notable festivals that include Berlin Atonal, Dark Mofo, Unsound, CTM, Roadburn, Donau Festival, Supersonic Festival, Le Guess Who? et al. As well as having embarked on a multitude of tours of Europe and the United Kingdom, North America, Japan, and the far reaches of Southeast Asia, and Australia.

He has worked with esteemed recording engineers that include Steve Albini at Electrical Audio, Boris Wilsdorf at andereBaustelle, Seth Manchester at Machines With Magnets, Ingo Krauss, and Cornel Wilczek at Electric Dreams.